

**Board 1**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4  
♥ J 4 3  
♦ J 8 6  
♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ 10 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 6 2  
♥ Q 2  
♦ 10 5 3 2  
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | Pass | 1♦    |
| Pass        | 1♠    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 5♣    |
| Pass        | 5♦    | Pass | 5♥    |
| Pass        | 6♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by South |       |      |       |

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that North has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

**Board 2**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 4  
♥ 10 4 2  
♦ 2  
♣ J 10 9 7 5

♠ A 6 3

♥ A K 9 8 6 5

♦ K

♣ A 3 2



♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 7

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 3

♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5

♣ K

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♥   | Pass | 2 ♦   |
| Pass         | 3 ♥   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 5 ♣   | Pass | 5NT   |
| Pass         | 6 ♦   | Pass | 7NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 7NT by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7 3  
♥ 7 4  
♦ A 6 5 3 2  
♣ 9 4

♠ -

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J 10 8 3



♠ A J 9 5 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8

♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ 10

♣ A K Q 6

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1♥    |
| Pass        | 3♠    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass        | 6♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by South |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 2  
 ♥ 9 5 3 2  
 ♦ A Q J 10 4  
 ♣ Q 9 8

♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K J 10 2



♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       | Pass | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 4 ♦   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 6 ♦   | Pass | 7 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 7 ♠ by South |       |      |       |

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.